12.2.2 Discovery of Protons

The presence of positively charged particles in the atom has been precisely predicted by Goldstein based on the conception that the atom being electrically neutral in nature, should necessarily possess positively charged particles to balance the negatively charged electrons.

Goldstein repeated the cathode ray experiment by using a perforated cathode. On applying a high voltage under low pressure, he observed a faint red glow on the wall behind the cathode. Since these rays originated from the anode, they were called anode rays or canal rays or positive rays. Anode rays were found as a stream of positively charged particles.

DO YOU KNOW?

When invisible radiation falls on materials like zinc sulphide, they emit a visible light (or glow). These materials are called fluorescent materials.

Properties of Anode rays

- Anode rays travel in straight lines.
- Anode rays are made up of material particles.
- Anode rays are deflected by electric and magnetic fields. Since, they are deflected towards the negatively charged plate, they consist of positively charged particles.
- The properties of anode rays depend upon the nature of the gas taken inside in the discharge tube.
- The mass of the particle is the same as the atomic mass of the gas taken inside the discharge tube.

DO YOU KNOW?

When hydrogen gas was taken in a discharge tube, the positively charged particles obtained from the hydrogen gas were called protons. Each of these protons are produced when one electron is removed from one hydrogen atom. Thus, a proton can be defined as an hydrogen ion (H^+).

$$H \rightarrow H^+ + e^-$$

12.2.3 Discovery of Neutrons

At the time of J.J.Thomson, only two fundamental particles (proton and electron) were known. In the year 1932, James Chadwick discovered another fundamental particle, called neutron. But, the proper position of these particles in an atom was not clear till Rutherford described the structure of atom. You will study about Rutherford's atom model in your higher classes.

Properties of Neutrons

- Neutron carries no charge. It is a neutral particle.
- It has mass equal to that of a proton, that is 1.6×10^{-24} grams.

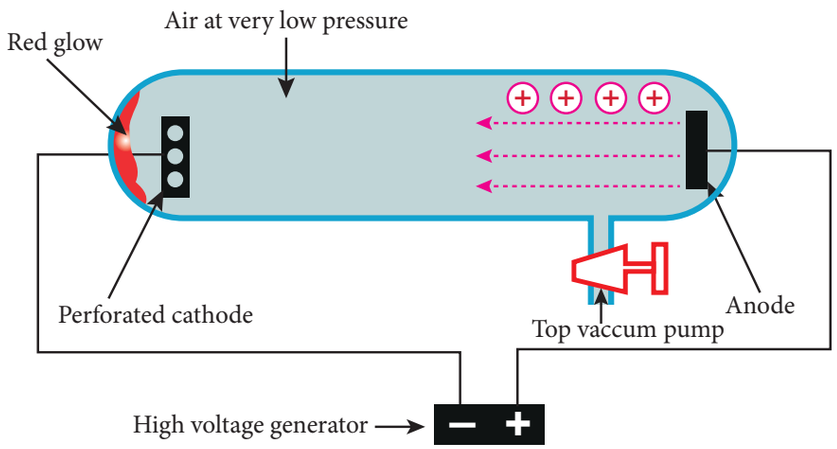


Figure 12.3 Emission of Protons

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